

A

Getting a job*

“When I left school, I **applied for**¹ jobs in different companies, and finally, after sending out lots of **CVs**² and having some **interviews**³, a small company **employed** me⁴. I didn't earn a lot, but the company gave me some **training**⁵, which was good.”

* finding a job

¹ wrote a letter of **application** for

² a document which describes your education and the jobs you have done

³ a meeting where someone asks you questions to see if you are suitable for a job

⁴ gave me a job

⁵ help and advice to learn how to do a job or activity

Common mistakes

I had **some training**. (NOT I had a ~~training~~.) You can also **go on / do a training course** [a period of organised help and advice, often in a different place] (NOT ~~formation~~ or ~~stage~~).

B

Promotion

“I worked hard and soon I was **promoted** [given a better job with more responsibility]. They also gave me a good **pay rise** [more money]. It was really good **experience** [knowledge you get from doing something such as a job], and when my boss left the company a few years later, they gave me an important **promotion** [a move to a higher job in the company].”

C

Resignation*

“By my mid-twenties, I was getting a bit bored, and decided I wanted to work **abroad** [in another country]. So, I **quit my job** [told the company I was leaving; *syn* **resign**] and started looking for jobs in the UK. After a couple of months I got a job in London. At first I liked it, but ...”

* when you say officially you are leaving a job

D

Unemployment*

“After six months, I got fed up with the job – and I think I was enjoying myself too much to work very hard. Finally, the company **sacked** me [told me to leave the company; *syn* **gave me the sack**], and after that I was **unemployed** [without a job; *syn* **out of work**] for two months. Finally I got a **part-time** job [working only part of the day or week; *opp* **full-time** job] in the kitchen of a restaurant.”

* when people do not have a job

Common mistakes

Claudio didn't **have a job**. (NOT He didn't have a ~~work~~.)

E

Success and retirement*



Claudio

“I loved the restaurant. I learned how to cook, and two years later I became manager. Three years after that I opened my **own** restaurant. [belonging to me / it was my restaurant] It was very **successful** [it did well and made money], and twenty years later, I **owned** five restaurants, and I was the **owner** of two hotels. I believe anyone can **succeed** [be successful] if they work hard enough – and have a little bit of luck. Last year, aged sixty, I **retired** and went back to Italy.”

* the time when people stop work, often at 60 or 65

Exercises

37.1 Match the answers on the right with the questions on the left.

- 1 Why did they sack him?

2 Why did they promote him?

3 Why did he apply for the job?

4 Why did he retire?

5 Why did he quit his job?

6 Why did he go on the course?
- c

a Because he was 65.

b Because he needed more training.

c Because he was late for work every day.

d Because he was out of work.

e Because he was the best person in the department.

f Because he didn't like his boss.

37.2 Complete the table.

verb	noun	adjective
employ	(un)employment	
promote		
retire		
resign		
	success	
own		

37.3 Complete the sentences.

- 1 Lucy is hoping to *get*..... a job in a travel agency when she leaves school.

2 I decided to work to see what life was like in another country.

3 I don't want a full-time job. I'd prefer to work

4 She her job when her boss refused to give her a pay

5 I didn't earn much money in the job, but it was still good because the company sent me on several training

6 After they sacked me, I was out of for six months.

7 It's not easy to in business; you need ability and luck.

8 I think you should definitely for that job.

9 Ivan was terrible as a tour guide; that's why they gave him the

10 I've worked for other people most of my life, but I'd really like to run my company.

11 I used to a company but it wasn't a ; I lost a lot of money.

12 If she's interested in that job, she'll have to write a letter of

37.4 Over to you

If you have a job, answer the questions. If possible, ask someone else the same questions.

- 1 Have you been promoted since you started working at your present company?

2 Do you normally get a good pay rise at the end of each year?

3 Have you been on many training courses since you started work?

4 Would you like to go on more training courses in the future?

5 Have you ever resigned from a job, or been given the sack?